RePermit: solution description

What RePermit does, the use cases it covers, the data it uses, the roles of AI and people, and how it works technically · 9 November 2026

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Summary

RePermit is an application with which a consultant prepares and submits a complete application for a modification to a permitted building design in Dubai. It checks the modification in advance against Dubai law and regulations, the same rules the authority applies. It determines what kind of modification it is, which rules and disciplines are affected, which documents are required and whether they are present, complete and current. What is missing, it requests through documents and the BIM model. When new information arrives it reassesses; when rules conflict or a procedure is unclear it escalates to a person; and every step is recorded with its reasons. Once the file is complete, an internal reviewer releases it and the consultant submits it to the authority.

Decisions rest with a deterministic rules engine and with people. AI advises: it classifies, reads documents, searches the BIM model and the regulations, and drafts questions. The permit decision is taken by the competent authority in its own portal; RePermit does not replace that judgement.

The rules are derived from public Dubai sources and validated by an expert. For the demo we handle one type of permit: modifications to existing apartment buildings.

1. Business context

The process

Anyone in Dubai who wants to modify a permitted, often already completed, building needs approval from the competent authority: Dubai Municipality (DM) through the Building Permits System (BPS), or in the free zones and development areas an authority such as the Dubai Development Authority (DDA). The route depends on the authority, on whether the building has been completed, and on the kind of modification: renovation, modification, reconstruction, change of use or addition. An engineering firm (the consultant) prepares the application and is the authority's point of contact.

The problem

- Unclear what is required. The required documents differ per case: an owner NOC, structural calculations, a Civil Defence NOC, an assessment of the affected area, a planning exemption. This is spread across laws, circulars, service descriptions and the Dubai Building Code (over 1,600 passages on its own), partly only in Arabic.
- Incomplete applications and extra rounds. Missing or wrong documents lead to rejection and resubmission. Internationally this is the step where automation pays off most: in Bellevue (US) the share of applications complete at first submission rose from 22% to 67% in a test.
- A change has knock-on effects. A relocated wall looks harmless but later turns out to be a fire separation. Earlier documents and approvals then no longer hold. Without systematic impact analysis this is discovered late.
- Little traceability. Afterwards it is often impossible to see which rule, document and person led to a step.

What RePermit does about it

- Checks the modification in advance against Dubai law and regulations: Local Order 3/1999, the Civil Defence law, the Dubai Building Code and the authority's service descriptions.
- Determines the type of modification, the affected disciplines and the applicable rules, with source and article.
- Derives which documents and facts are required, and checks whether they are present, complete, of the right revision and valid.
- Requests what is missing in plain language: which document, why, and whose turn it is.
- Reassesses as soon as new information arrives, and moves the case back when earlier conclusions no longer hold.
- Escalates to a person when rules conflict, the procedure has a gap or there are risks the rules do not cover, instead of inventing a rule.
- Records every step: who or what decided, on the basis of which rules, documents and sources.
- After internal release, delivers a complete, substantiated file to submit to the authority.

Who it is for

For the consultant or permit coordinator on the applicant's side, who wants to know before submitting how the authority will assess the application, and to submit a complete one. Within the firm, an internal reviewer, for example a senior engineer, releases the file. The authority receives a complete file with substantiation per rule and document, and takes the decision itself. In August 2026 Dubai Municipality announced its own AI agent that is to issue villa permits automatically. RePermit sits on the other side of that counter: it makes sure that what comes in is complete and compliant.

2. Scope of the demo

The demo covers one type of permit: a modification to an existing, completed apartment building under the Dubai Development Authority. This lets us show the whole process, from submission to decision, with one coherent set of rules, documents and BIM models. The demo cases take place in a synthetic 12-storey apartment building.

In the demo	Outside the demo
Changes within an apartment: moving walls, merging or splitting apartments, floors, ceilings and finishes	Villas and single-family houses
Changes in common areas: lobby, corridors, escape routes and building services	New construction and new permits
Changes that affect the building: load-bearing walls, fire separations, facade	Offices, shops and other non-residential buildings
Edge cases on the outside: enclosing a terrace, a rooftop extension	Buildings under Dubai Municipality or other authorities, heritage

Two existing AI test cases concern offices (an office fit-out and converting offices to apartments); they fall outside this scope and remain available only as examples.

3. Use cases

RePermit is built on UC-01 Process a Building-Permit Design Modification (use case specification version 1.0, 18 October 2026). The primary actor is the consultant or coordinator; the authority is simulated.

Basic flow (H0)

Step	What the use case requires	How RePermit does it
H0.1	Consultant submits the modification	Description, revision and optionally the type; the IFC model is uploaded and compared with the approved model
H0.2	Retrieve project state, drawings and evidence	The file is built from the event log: every document with version and revision
H0.3	Determine rules and affected domains	The rules engine applies the rule set; AI classifies and assesses per domain, with source passages
H0.4	Determine affected documents and approvals	Per document: still valid, to be checked, or to be revalidated
H0.5	Check evidence for completeness, consistency and revision	Checklist per document type, revision and validity checks, contradictory facts
H0.6	Plan the next step	Next action and the roles allowed to perform it
H0.7	Check autonomy and authorization	May the system do this itself, or is a person needed; the role is checked
H0.8	Execute or hand over the action	Prepare the package, release it internally and submit it to the authority, by authorized roles only; in the demo the authority's decision is simulated
H0.9	Record everything	Every step in the event log; can be replayed and is explained per step in the Flow

Exceptions (E1–E6)

Flow	Situation	How RePermit responds
E1	Evidence missing or insufficient	The step is held; the missing document is requested, with an upload button at the item itself
E2	New design revision	Earlier evidence is marked as belonging to an old revision; impact is determined again
E3	Conflicting rules	The system does not choose; escalation to the internal reviewer, who asks the authority for clarification if needed
E4	Role may not perform the action	Action refused and recorded; the case does not change
E5	Late material information	The case returns to the start of the stage; earlier conclusions lapse
E6	Gap in procedure or authority	Escalation instead of an improvised procedure

Supporting functions

- BIM: reading IFC models, comparing them with the approved model, deriving facts (load-bearing, fire separation, facade) and letting the AI query them through tools.
- Documents: uploading, storing and opening PDFs; a checklist per document type; the AI reads, the code decides whether a document is complete, and a person confirms the facts.
- Review rounds: add information and have it reassessed, at most four rounds; after that a person takes over.
- Cost control: hard limits per case ($1) and per day ($5); tokens and costs recorded per AI call.
- Settings: model and effort per AI component, number of BIM tool calls, retrieval settings and budgets, with a change history.
- Knowledge: the rules, sources and the searchable knowledge index can be viewed in the app.
- Demo: 9 fixed test cases for the flows and 8 AI cases in the apartment building, from replacing floors and a wall between two apartments to a rooftop extension.

4. Data and processing

RePermit uses six kinds of data. In the demo all cases, documents and models are synthetic.

Data	Origin	Processing	Storage
Rule set	Derived by hand from public sources: Local Order 3/1999, Law 4/2025 (Civil Defence), Law 6/2019, the Dubai Building Code, DDA service descriptions and circulars	20 rules, 7 known gaps, 16 document types with checklists, 5 modification types and 6 domains; every rule with source and article; interpretations labelled	YAML in the code, versioned (for example dubai-public-2026.4); each case keeps its version, old versions are retained
Knowledge index	Full texts of 15 public sources plus 14 own summaries (knowledge cards)	Downloaded, split per article with authority and validity, turned into embeddings by a local model; hybrid search, at most 5 articles and 3 cards per review (see section 6)	Vector database (PostgreSQL with pgvector) plus a keyword index, within our own environment
BIM models	IFC files from the applicant; in the demo a synthetic 12-storey apartment building	Read with IfcOpenShell; per element the class, storey, properties, quantities and material; compared with the approved model by GlobalId; facts derived	In the event log with the evidence item
Documents	PDFs from the applicant (synthetic in the demo)	Text extracted; each checklist item assessed by the AI or the internal reviewer; facts only count after confirmation	Text in the event log, the file itself by checksum (SHA-256)
Answers and notes	Entered by the applicant	Only the opening question (competent authority) counts directly; other text is context and proves nothing	Event log

Data	Origin	Processing	Storage
Event log	Every step in every case	Each event is appended, never changed; the status follows from the sequence; every step can be replayed	PostgreSQL, with daily backups

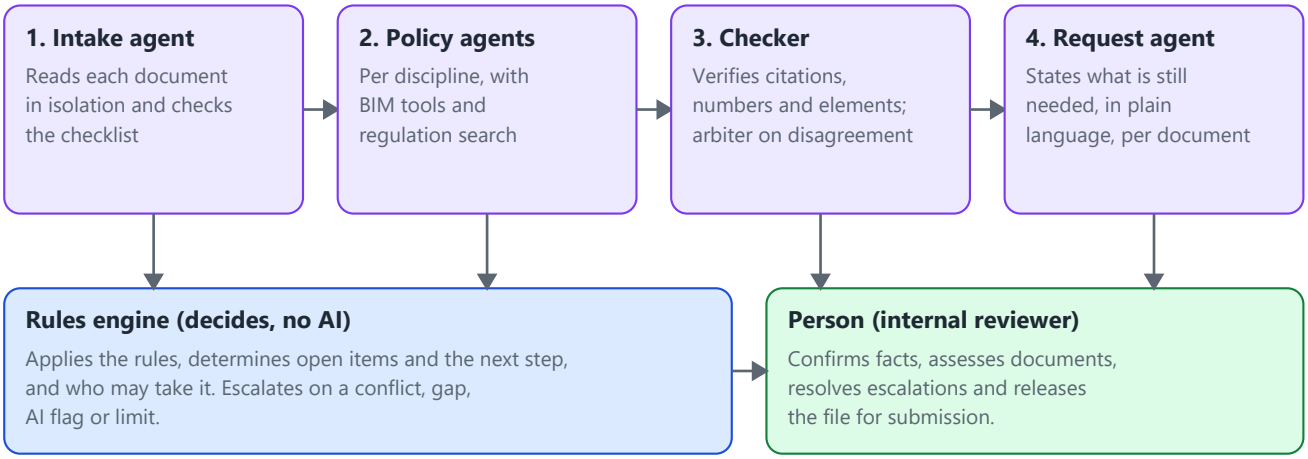
What goes to the AI

For each review RePermit sends to the AI model (TBD, sandbox): the description of the modification, the established facts, the evidence metadata, the text of documents not yet read, the model comparison, the source passages and the answers from the BIM tools. The full IFC file and documents already assessed are not sent. Each call records the model, the tokens and the estimated cost. Text from documents and models is treated as data, not as instructions.

5. Agents and the role of people

Agent architecture

RePermit works with a fixed sequence of specialised agents around one shared case file. This design follows from research into existing systems (CivCheck in Seattle, CORENET X in Singapore, recent academic studies). The agents do not talk freely to each other; the code sets the order, and the rules engine and people decide.



All steps read from and write to one shared case file (the event log). Purple = AI (advises), blue = rules, green = person.

Agent	Does	Does not	Model
Intake agent	Reads each new document separately, checks type, case and revision, works through the checklist, extracts facts with a quote	No tools, no decision on completeness	TBD (sandbox)
Policy agents	Per discipline (structure, fire, planning, property): assesses with BIM tools and regulation search, citing sources	Apply rules or deviate from the rule set	TBD (sandbox)
Checker	Verifies that citations, numbers and BIM elements are right; arbiter only when AI and rules disagree	Draw conclusions of its own	TBD (sandbox)

Agent	Does	Does not	Model
Request agent	Turns open items into a clear request: which document, why, whose turn	Treat anything as proven	TBD (sandbox)

What people do

Role	Responsibility
Consultant / coordinator	Submits the modification, provides model and documents, answers questions, prepares the package and submits it
Internal reviewer	Senior engineer or quality controller at the consultant. Confirms or rejects facts the AI read from documents, assesses documents directly, resolves escalations and releases the file for submission
Competent authority	DDA or Dubai Municipality: assesses the submitted application in its own portal and takes the decision. Simulated in the demo
Observer	Follows the case, without actions
Rule set expert	Validates rules and interpretations, approves proposals for new rules
Administrator	Sets models, budgets and retrieval settings within the limits of the server

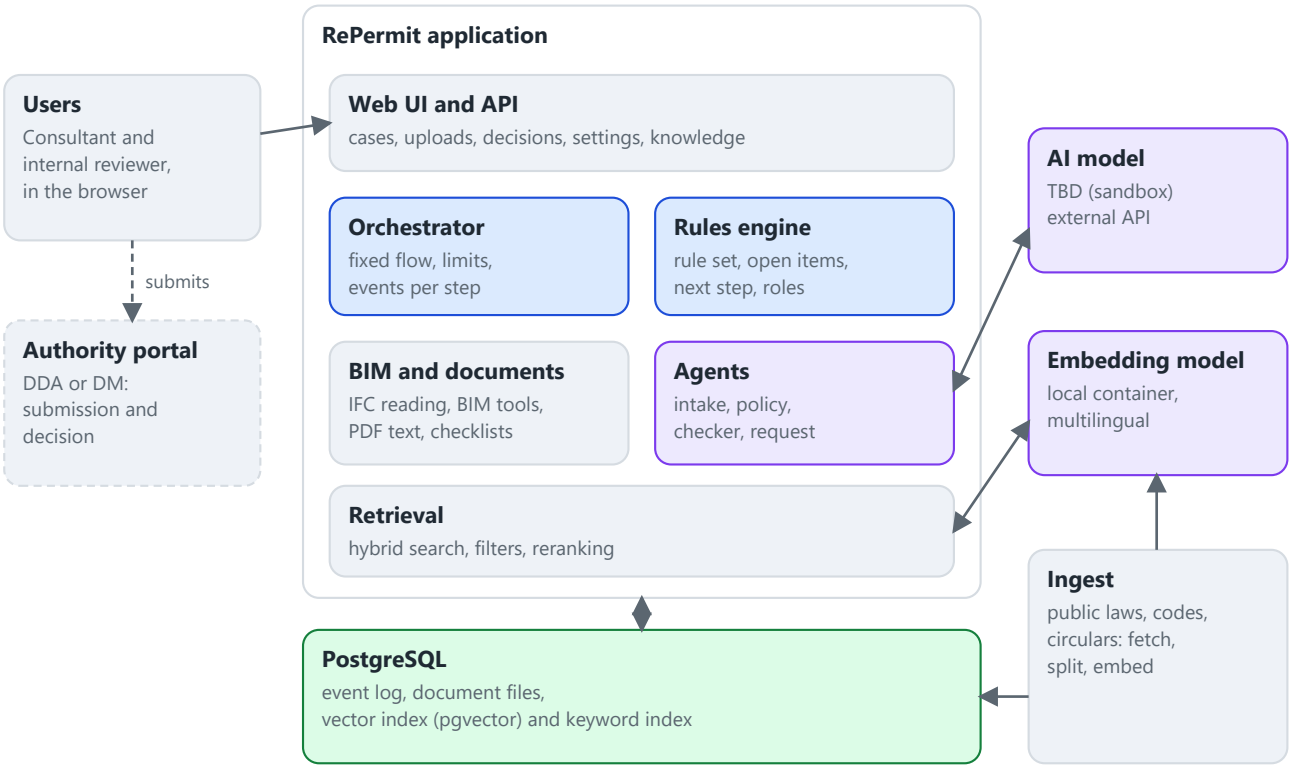
Principles: the AI advises, the rules decide; the AI may speed up a 'yes', every 'no' goes through a person; every step is visible in the Flow with who decided and on what basis. The permit decision stays with the authority; RePermit makes sure it receives a complete, substantiated file.

6. Technical design

This section describes how a case moves through RePermit technically, how the AI steps are set up and how the legal and regulatory texts are made searchable through embeddings.

Architecture

RePermit runs in our own environment: the application, a local embedding model and PostgreSQL. Only the AI model is an external service. Users work in the browser; the application prepares the file, and submission and the decision take place in the authority's portal.



Grey = external or supporting, blue = deterministic, purple = AI, green = data. Dashed = outside RePermit.

Flow of a case

Step	Who	What happens technically
1. Submission	Applicant	The modification and IFC model arrive. The app reads the model, compares it with the approved model and derives facts such as load-bearing, fire separation and facade
2. Retrieve knowledge	Retrieval	A search query is built from the case. The vector database returns the best-matching articles and knowledge cards, filtered by authority and validity
3. AI steps	Agents	Intake reads the documents, the policy agents assess per discipline with BIM tools and the retrieved articles, the checker verifies their outcome
4. Rules check	Rules engine	Applies the rule set and determines open items, conflicts and gaps, the next step and who may take it
5. Requests and release	People	The consultant provides what is missing. The internal reviewer confirms facts, resolves escalations and releases the file; then it is submitted to the authority. New information restarts the flow from step 2

Every step is recorded as an event in the case file. Before every AI call the app checks the limits for rounds and budget.

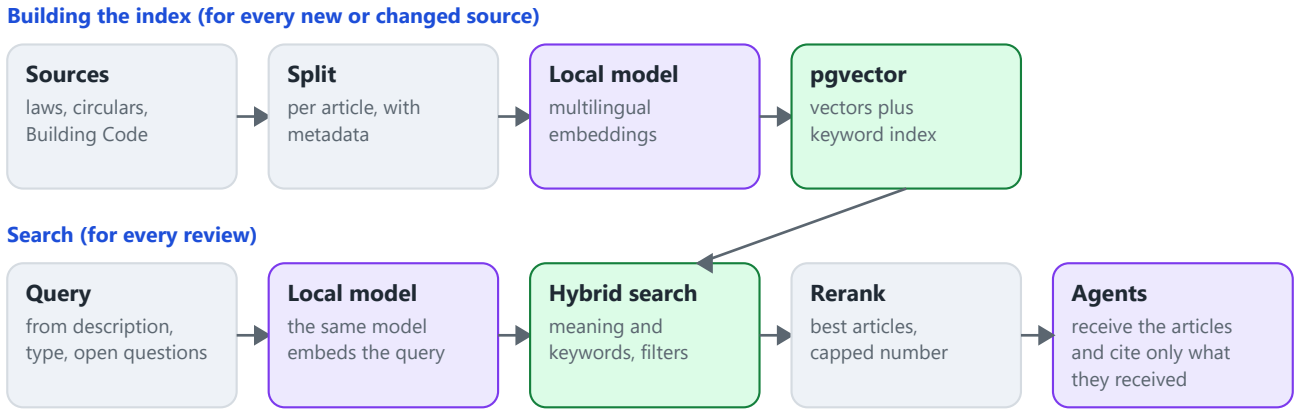
Agents

Agent	Receives	Returns	May use
Intake	New documents with their checklist	Per document: right type, belongs to the case, checklist items, facts with a quote	Nothing: no tools
Policy (per discipline)	Case, established facts, model comparison, retrieved articles	Findings per domain, questions, citations	BIM tools: overview, find elements, inspect an element, what is nearby
Checker	Outcome of the policy agents and the evidence	Agreement or deviations with reasons	The same BIM tools, read only
Request	Open items from the rules engine	Request to the applicant in plain language	Nothing

All agents return a fixed response schema. Each agent has its own model, effort and limit, set on the Settings page, and records its tokens and cost. Text from documents and models is data, never instructions.

Embedding of legal and regulatory texts

The legal and regulatory texts are turned into vectors by a local embedding model and stored in a vector database. A local model keeps the source texts within our own environment, which is required because they may only be used internally.



Building the index

- Fetch: the sources on the source list (laws, circulars, Dubai Building Code, service descriptions) are downloaded; date, version and terms of use are recorded per source.
- Split: per article or clause, with the chapter heading added as context. Each chunk gets metadata: source, article number, authority (DDA, DM or all), in force or superseded, language and source version.
- Embed: a multilingual open model (for example from the BGE or E5 family) runs in its own container and turns each chunk into a vector. English and Arabic texts share the same vector space.
- Store: in PostgreSQL with the pgvector extension, next to a keyword index on the same chunks, so no separate database is added.
- Update: when a source changes, only that source's chunks are read and embedded again. Superseded articles are kept but no longer returned.

Search

- Hybrid: search by meaning (vectors) and by keywords, with the results merged. Legal texts contain exact terms and references, such as *Art. 17(4)* or *EI60*, that only keyword search finds reliably.
- Filters first: only chunks that apply to the competent authority, are still in force and come from an enabled source.
- Rerank: the best candidates are reordered and the number is capped at what is set on the Settings page (5 articles and 3 knowledge cards by default).
- Check: an agent may only cite chunks it received; the app removes any other citation. The retrieved chunks are shown per review in the Flow and can be browsed on the Knowledge page.
- Measure: a fixed set of test questions with the right articles. Keyword-only search reached a precision of about 75%; the vector index must demonstrably do better.

7. Design principles

- RePermit does not decide on a permit; the competent authority does. RePermit delivers a complete, substantiated file.
- The AI advises. What counts is established by the rules engine or the internal reviewer.
- The sources are a dated snapshot and are not complete. An outcome without open items means nothing is open under the current rule set, not that the application complies with every requirement (see Appendix B).
- The rule set translates law and regulation into conditions. Every rule and interpretation is validated by an expert and versioned; a new version applies only to new cases.
- The full source texts stay within our own environment; hence a local embedding model.
- Documents need a text layer; scanned documents are outside the first version.
- In the first version, submission takes place in the authority's portal; a direct integration follows once the authority offers one.
- See also the reports *RePermit: what it takes to mature the product* and *Agent architectures for building permits*.

Appendix A. Policies: the rule set

The rule set (dubai-public-2026.4) translates Dubai law and regulation into conditions. The rules engine applies them to each case and decides which domains are affected, which documents are required and what the next step is. Each rule cites its source and article. Where a rule rests on an interpretation, the rule says so, and the interpretation is validated by an expert.

Rule	What it requires	Domain	Source and article	Required documents
DXB-PRM-01	No construction without a permit	Permitting	Executive Council Resolution No. (65) of 2022, amending Local Order 3/1999: LO 3/1999 art. 4 as replaced by Res. 65/2022, and art. 14	Approved and proposed drawings showing the changes
DXB-PRM-02	Renovation beyond simple maintenance	Permitting	Administrative Resolution No. (109) of 2022 Regulating Licensing of Maintenance Works: AR 109/2022, with LO 3/1999 art. 4(b) as replaced by Res. 65/2022	Approved and proposed drawings showing the changes
DXB-SCP-01	Scope of a modification or renovation	Permitting	Dubai Building Code, 2021 Edition: Sec. A.5.1, Table A.1	–
DXB-ROU-01	Route after completion	Permitting	DDA Building Modification service pages: Building Modification service pages	–
DXB-ROU-02	Route before completion	Permitting	DDA Building Modification service pages: Design Revision service page	–
DXB-DOC-01	File for a design modification	Permitting	Building Modification Services' ID Cards, Issue 6, December 2021: M-02, documents 3 to 5	NOC from the building owner, Consultant appointment letter, Project Details Sheet, stamped by the consultant
DXB-STR-01	Structural calculations	Structure	Building Modification Services' ID Cards, Issue 6, December 2021: M-02, document 6	Structural calculations and model
DXB-STR-02	Change to main load-bearing elements	Structure	Administrative Resolution No. (109) of 2022 Regulating Licensing of Maintenance Works: AR 109/2022 and Circular 3-12-1	Structural calculations and model
DXB-FIR-01	Civil Defence NOC	Fire safety	Law No. (4) of 2025 Establishing the Dubai Civil Defence General Command: Art. 17(4) and 16(a)	NOC from Dubai Civil Defence
DXB-FIR-02	Change to a safety system	Fire safety	Law No. (4) of 2025 Establishing the Dubai Civil Defence General Command: Art. 17(4) and 19(c)	NOC from Dubai Civil Defence

Rule	What it requires	Domain	Source and article	Required documents
DXB-REC-01	Modification that is not stand-alone	Fire safety	Dubai Building Code, 2021 Edition: Sec. A.5.1, Table A.1	Assessment of the affected parts of the building
DXB-COU-01	Change of use	Fire safety	Dubai Building Code, 2021 Edition: Sec. A.5.1, Table A.1	Assessment of the affected parts of the building
DXB-USE-01	Change of planning use	Planning	Regulation No. (3) of 2007 on requests to amend land and building uses, with Administrative Resolution 266/2011: Regulation 3/2007 and AR 266/2011	Approval of the change of use request
DXB-ADD-01	Addition that relies on the existing building	Structure	Dubai Building Code, 2021 Edition: Sec. A.5.1, Table A.1	Assessment of the existing building
DXB-ZON-01	Deviation from planning rules	Planning	Building Modification Services' ID Cards, Issue 6, December 2021: C-11	Approved zoning exception
DXB-ZON-02	Deviation from planning rules under Dubai Municipality	Planning	Regulation No. (10) of 2006 on requests to amend planning and building regulations, with Administrative Resolution 266/2011: Regulation 10/2006 and AR 266/2011	Approval of the planning modification request
DXB-DEC-01	Decoration works licence	Permitting	Administrative Resolution No. (85) of 2019 Concerning the Licensing of Decoration Works: Art. 2 and 4	Decoration works licence, NOC from the building owner
DXB-DEC-02	Decoration work stays within the unit	Permitting	Administrative Resolution No. (85) of 2019 Concerning the Licensing of Decoration Works: Art. 2(3), 2(5), 4(b)(3) and 4(b)(5)	NOC from the building owner
DXB-HER-01	Facade in a heritage area	Heritage	Dubai Building Code, 2021 Edition: Sec. A.2 and A.5.1	Approval from the heritage department
DXB-OWN-01	Unit boundary in jointly owned property	Property	Law No. (6) of 2019 Concerning Ownership of Jointly Owned Real Property: Art. 9(e) and 39(a)	–

Known gaps

Some requirements could not be derived from the available sources. These gaps are part of the rule set: when one applies, the case always goes to the internal reviewer instead of the rules engine deciding.

Gap	What happens
DM-DOCS	The official Dubai Municipality document list for modifications (service 4127) could not be read. A competent reviewer must establish what is required.
OTHER-ENTITY	No rules exist for other authorities. Trakhees, DIFC and others have their own procedures, and a reviewer must establish the route.

Gap	What happens
FIRE-VALUES	The UAE Fire and Life Safety Code could not be read, so fire ratings and separation requirements must be established by a competent reviewer.
EXEMPT-WORKS	Simple maintenance can be exempt from a building permit. A reviewer must confirm that the exemption applies.
OWN-WALL	A unit boundary changes. A reviewer must establish the consent of both owners and any Dubai Land Department steps for changed areas. No text literally requires an NOC from the second owner.
OWN-COMMON	A structural wall can be a Common Part under art. 7 and art. 17. A reviewer must establish whether the owners committee or management entity must be involved.
HISTORICAL	The Building Code does not apply to historical buildings; authority guidelines apply to them, and these have not been researched.

How the rule set was derived

The rule set was derived from public sources in five steps. The derivation is documented in a source analysis, and the rule set is validated by an expert before it is used.

1. Finding and reading sources. Research into public Dubai regulation for modifications to existing buildings, followed by reading the usable sources: the Dubai Building Code 2021, mainly Part A with the modification types of Table A.1; Local Order 3/1999 (permit duty, art. 4 and 14) with Executive Council Resolution 65/2022, which replaces art. 4; the DDA Building Modification service cards (2021); Law 4/2025 on Civil Defence; Law 6/2019 on jointly owned property; Administrative Resolutions 85/2019 on decoration works (read in Arabic) and 109/2022 on maintenance; and Regulations 10/2006 and 3/2007 on changes to planning rules and use.
2. Translating requirements into conditions. Each requirement was written as "if [facts], then [consequence]", where the consequence is an affected domain or a required document. For example, the service card states "structural calculations, if applicable"; this became: if the modification is under DDA and affects a load-bearing element, structural calculations are required. Every rule cites its source and article.
3. Marking interpretations. Where a source gives no criterion, a choice was made and stated in the rule: "if applicable" became a load-bearing element; "may affect safety" became a fire separation; a relocated wall was treated as a substantial alteration of a shared dividing wall.
4. Recording what could not be derived. Sources that could not be read, and requirements that could not be derived, became the known gaps above. A gap always leads to escalation to a person.
5. Correcting in versions. The rule set went through four versions (2026.1 to 2026.4). Source research showed errors in the first version: it cited a replaced article, applied an authority-specific rule to every authority, and lacked the legal basis for the second owner of a dividing wall. These were corrected; later versions added document types with checklists and the order in which facts are asked. Earlier versions are kept so that running cases stay on their own version, and automated tests check that every required document has a checklist and every asked fact can be proven by a document.

Deliberately left out: figures from blogs (fees, lead times, thresholds), dimensions from the Building Code such as minimum room sizes, which need geometry the application does not read, and acoustic requirements.

Appendix B. Sources and how we use them

Every source is used in one or more of three ways:

- Rule derivation: the rules in Appendix A are derived from the source. These rules decide.
- Retrieval: the full text is split per article, embedded and searched for each review. The passages found are given to the agents as context and may be cited; they advise, they do not decide.
- Knowledge cards: own paraphrases for sources that are only available in Arabic or could not be downloaded (Appendix C).

All sources are public. Their reuse terms allow internal use only, so the full texts stay within our own environment.

Source	Issuer, year	Applies to	How we use it
Dubai Building Code, 2021 Edition	Dubai Municipality, 2021	All	Rules: DXB-SCP-01, DXB-REC-01, DXB-COU-01, DXB-ADD-01, DXB-HER-01; Retrieval: 1,622 passages
Local Order No. (3) of 1999 Regulating Construction Works in the Emirate of Dubai	Chairman of Dubai Municipality, 1999	DM	Cited in rules: DXB-PRM-01, DXB-PRM-02; Retrieval: 41 passages
Administrative Resolution No. (85) of 2019 Concerning the Licensing of Decoration Works	Dubai Municipality	–	Rules: DXB-DEC-01, DXB-DEC-02
Building Modification Services' ID Cards, Issue 6, December 2021	Dubai Development Authority	–	Rules: DXB-DOC-01, DXB-STR-01, DXB-ZON-01
RePermit register of requirements that could not be read	RePermit source analysis (docs/source-analysis.md)	–	Known gaps in Appendix A
Executive Council Resolution No. (65) of 2022, amending Local Order 3/1999	Chairman of the Executive Council	–	Rules: DXB-PRM-01
Administrative Resolution No. (109) of 2022 Regulating Licensing of Maintenance Works	Dubai Municipality	–	Rules: DXB-PRM-02, DXB-STR-02
Law No. (6) of 2019 Concerning Ownership of Jointly Owned Real Property	Ruler of Dubai, 2019	All	Rules: DXB-OWN-01; Retrieval: 71 passages
Law No. (4) of 2025 Establishing the Dubai Civil Defence General Command	Ruler of Dubai, 2025	All	Rules: DXB-FIR-01, DXB-FIR-02; Retrieval: 54 passages
Regulation No. (10) of 2006 on requests to amend planning and building regulations, with Administrative Resolution 266/2011	Chairman of the Executive Council	–	Rules: DXB-ZON-02
Regulation No. (3) of 2007 on requests to amend land and building uses, with Administrative Resolution 266/2011	Chairman of the Executive Council	–	Rules: DXB-USE-01
DDA Building Modification service pages	Dubai Development Authority	–	Rules: DXB-ROU-01, DXB-ROU-02

Source	Issuer, year	Applies to	How we use it
Decree No. (45) of 2021 Concerning the Dubai Building Code	Ruler of Dubai, 2021	All	Retrieval: 11 passages
Law No. (3) of 2026 Concerning the Quality and Safety of Buildings	Ruler of Dubai, 2026	All	Retrieval: 38 passages
Administrative Resolution No. (227) of 2022 Concerning Exemption from Certain Planning Requirements	Dubai Municipality, 2022	DM	Retrieval: 14 passages
Administrative Resolution No. (37) of 2021 Amending the Bylaw on Building Requirements	Dubai Municipality, 2021	DM	Retrieval: 56 passages
Circular 5-1-1 Concerning Fire Prevention	Dubai Municipality, 2021	DM	Retrieval: 1 passage
Circular 9-1-1 Application of Buildings Information Modelling	Dubai Municipality, 2021	DM	Retrieval: 1 passage
Circular 2-2-1 Implementation of Administrative Resolution No. 227 of 2022	Dubai Municipality, 2022	DM	Retrieval: 3 passages
Procedure for Multistorey Buildings	Dubai Municipality, 2020	DM	Retrieval: 2 passages
FAQ for Buildings Permit Procedures and Regulations	Dubai Municipality, 2023	DM	Retrieval: 18 passages
Client Procedure for Obtaining Modification Permits (CP-01)	PCFC Trakhees, 2024	Trakhees	Retrieval: 2 passages

Applies to: the authority a passage applies to in retrieval. All = every authority, DM = Dubai Municipality, – = not in the retrieval index.

Currency and completeness

We cannot guarantee that the sources are current or complete. They are a snapshot: all sources were retrieved on 1 November 2026, and later amendments are not included until the rule set is updated.

- Not current: laws, resolutions and circulars are amended over time. Known amendments are recorded per source, for example Local Order 3/1999 by Local Order 6/2000 and Executive Council Resolution 65/2022, and the Dubai Building Code by Administrative Resolution 225/2024. Amendments we do not know about cannot be recorded.
- Not complete: some requirements are known to be missing, such as the Dubai Municipality document list for modifications, the UAE Fire and Life Safety Code, the procedures of other authorities and the guidelines for historical buildings. Arabic-only texts are covered only by unverified knowledge cards. Unpublished authority practice is not available at all.
- Consequence: an outcome without open items means that nothing is open under the current rule set, not that the application complies with every requirement. The authority's assessment remains decisive.

How we keep the sources current

- Every source records its retrieval date, its publication date and the instruments known to amend it.
- Before a rule set version is used, the rule set expert confirms that its sources are current.
- Sources are checked again at fixed intervals and whenever a change is announced. A change leads to a new rule set version; running cases keep the version they started with.
- Corrections requested by the authority on submitted applications are reviewed for missing or outdated rules.
- Known gaps (Appendix A) always go to the internal reviewer.

Appendix C. Knowledge cards

Knowledge cards are short paraphrases written for sources that are only available in Arabic or could not be downloaded. They are retrieved like source passages and marked as unverified until an expert confirms them.

Card	Paraphrases	Applies to
RES65-ART4	Executive Council Resolution 65/2022, new art. 4 of Local Order 3/1999	DM
RES65-ART8	Executive Council Resolution 65/2022, new art. 8 of Local Order 3/1999	DM
LAW6-WALL	Law 6/2019, art. 9(e)	All
LAW6-ALTERATIONS	Law 6/2019, art. 39(a)	All
DLD-MERGE	Dubai Land Department FAQ	All
LAW4-NOTIFY	Law 4/2025, art. 17(4)	All
BIM-MODIFICATION	Circular 9-1-3 of 2026, Part II	DM
BIM-NEW	Circulars 9-1-2 of 2023 and 9-1-3 of 2026	DM
AR225-SMALL-PLOTS	Administrative Resolution 225/2024	All
AR109-MAINTENANCE	Administrative Resolution 109/2022 and Circular 3-12-1	DM
REG3-USE	Regulation 3/2007 and Administrative Resolution 266/2011	DM
REG10-PARAMETERS	Regulation 10/2006 and Administrative Resolution 266/2011	DM
AR85-DECORATION	Administrative Resolution 85/2019	DM
FIRE-CODE-GAP	UAE Fire and Life Safety Code of Practice, September 2018	All

Appendix D. Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
AI	Artificial intelligence; in this document a language model that advises
API	Application programming interface
AR	Administrative Resolution, issued by Dubai Municipality
BIM	Building Information Modelling: a digital model of the building with its elements and properties
BPS	Building Permits System of Dubai Municipality
DBC	Dubai Building Code, 2021 Edition
DDA	Dubai Development Authority: the permit authority for the free zones and development areas it manages
DM	Dubai Municipality: the permit authority for the rest of Dubai, and issuer of the Dubai Building Code
IFC	Industry Foundation Classes: the open file format for BIM models
LO	Local Order, issued by the Chairman of Dubai Municipality
NOC	No Objection Certificate: a statement from a party, such as the owner or Civil Defence, that it does not object
PCFC Trakhees	The permit authority of the Ports, Customs and Free Zone Corporation for its own areas
PDF	Portable Document Format
Res.	Resolution, for example of the Executive Council of Dubai
UAE	United Arab Emirates
UI	User interface